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The TRANSFORM Method

The framework in a nutshell: a free quick start

FREE QUICK START

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> **Disclaimer.** This educational resource presents behavioral frameworks for personal development. It does not constitute medical, psychological, psychiatric or therapeutic advice. The author is a nutrition coach, not a licensed healthcare provider. If you have a mental health condition, an eating disorder, a substance dependence or any other clinical concern, consult a qualified professional before making changes. Stopping alcohol after heavy use can be dangerous and should be done with medical guidance. Individual results vary.

FREE QUICK START

Start here

This is the free quick start of the TRANSFORM Method. It covers the big picture, the first three steps (Track, Redesign, Act) and your first 30 days. The complete guide adds the other steps, sobriety and recovery, ADHD, troubleshooting and worksheets.

The complete guide

The full edition is $9.90 with 5 complete guides, in PDF, with a 15 day refund.
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CHAPTER 1

Why I wrote this

I grew up in a very small town, with ADHD that nobody noticed. I kept starting things and kept losing them, and I explained it to myself the only way I knew: I was lazy, undisciplined, not like other people. I suffered for almost two decades in silence.

Today I have 8 years of CrossFit behind me, 4 years sober and 2 years in treatment for ADHD. None of that came from a burst of willpower. It came from small decisions, repeated in a setting I slowly learned to rebuild: what was in my house, who I spent time with, what I tracked, what I did on the day I fell off.

I also lost 38 kg of fat. I hold Precision Nutrition certifications, and I work as a nutrition coach with people who want to change how they eat, train and live. I do this because I want to help people avoid the doubts that made me suffer for so long. The pattern I see is always the same: they do not lack desire. They lack a system that survives a bad week.

> *Your life will not be perfect. But it can be a lot lighter, and it does not have to be done alone, or in silence.*

That is the reason this guide exists, and the reason it is priced so low. I wish someone had handed it to me 20 years ago.

CHAPTER 2

The TRANSFORM Method at a glance

The framework has nine steps, one for each letter of the word TRANSFORM. They are cyclical, not linear: you will come back to earlier steps as your life changes.

Letter	Step	The question it answers
T	**Track** your reality	What am I actually doing, and what comes right before it?
R	**Redesign** your environment	How do I make the right action easy and the wrong action hard?
A	**Act** with minimum viable habits	What is the smallest version I can do even on a terrible day?
N	**Navigate** setbacks	What is my plan for when it goes wrong?
S	**Solidify** your identity	Who am I becoming, and how do I see the proof?
F	**Focus** on one thing	What is the ONE behavior for the next 30 days?
O	**Optimize** gradually	How do I make it a little bigger without breaking it?
R	**Repeat** daily	What does consistency look like on my worst day?
M	**Maintain** and review	How do I keep it for years, and what do I do when life changes?

Why one behavior at a time? Because Lally's data shows habits can take months to settle, and each change you start competes for the same limited attention. This is my recommendation based on that data, not a rule proven by a trial: **two or three habits that never stick are worth less than one habit that does.**

CHAPTER 3

T: Track your reality

Before you change anything, spend one week collecting data without judgment. You are not trying to be good. You are a researcher studying one subject: you.

There is good evidence that monitoring your own behavior helps, especially for eating and weight. A systematic review of weight-loss studies found a consistent association between self-monitoring and weight loss, though the authors rated the evidence as weak because of study limitations.[1] A later meta-analysis of randomized trials found that digital self-monitoring of diet and activity was linked to about 2.9 kg more weight loss than comparison conditions.[2] Tracking does not do the work for you, but it shows you what to fix.

What to write down

- **What** you did and **when**
- **Where** you were, and **who** was around
- **How you felt** before (energy 1 to 10, mood in one word)
- **What happened right before** (the trigger)

Track the **behavior**, not only the result. Weight, bank balance and race times are outcomes. They move slowly and tell you little about why. The behaviors and cues are what you can change tomorrow.

The one-week tracking template

Time	Behavior	Where / who	Mood & energy	Trigger
7:00	Snoozed alarm 3 times	Bedroom, alone	Tired, 3	Phone alarm across the room
12:30	Fast food lunch	Office, coworkers	Stressed, 6	Meeting ran long
15:00	Coffee and a pastry	Break room	Bored, 5	Afternoon slump
20:00	Streaming, no dinner prep	Couch, alone	Lonely, 3	Nothing planned
23:00	Scrolled in bed	Bedroom	Anxious, 2	Could not sleep

Use paper, a notes app, a spreadsheet, or voice memos. The best tool is the one you will actually open. If you have ADHD, **set a phone alarm three times a day** that says "log it." Do not rely on remembering.

Read your week

After seven days, look for patterns in five places: **time** (evenings?), **place** (couch? car?), **people** (alone? one specific person?), **emotion** (stress, boredom, loneliness) and **energy**. Then answer these questions in writing:

1. What am I proud of this week?
2. Which behavior do I most want to change?
3. What usually comes right before it?
4. At what time of day and in what state am I most vulnerable?
5. What behavior do I want to build instead?
6. What would make that behavior easier?

Today

Open your notes app and create the log. Write down the last three things you did and what came right before each. You have started.

CHAPTER 4

R: Redesign your environment

Now you use what you found. Environmental design has one rule: **make the behavior you want obvious and easy, and the behavior you want to stop invisible and hard.**

Add friction to what you want less of

- **Phone:** charge it outside the bedroom, turn on grayscale, remove the one or two apps that eat your day.
- **Food:** do not keep the foods you overeat at home. If you buy them, put them out of sight (opaque container, high shelf).
- **Alcohol:** remove it from your home entirely. This is covered in the complete guide.
- **TV and streaming:** log out after each use so starting requires effort.

Remove friction from what you want more of

- **Training:** lay out clothes the night before, pack the bag, put it by the door.

- **Eating well:** prepare vegetables when you get home from the market, keep them in clear containers at eye level.
- **Reading or journaling:** leave the book on the pillow or the notebook on the desk, open.
- **Water:** fill a bottle and keep it where you work.

I call this the "seconds test." Count how many seconds stand between you and each behavior. Your goal is to make the wanted behavior a few seconds away and the unwanted one at least a minute away. This is my practical rule of thumb, not a laboratory threshold, but it matches what habit research says about context: the easiest thing in your environment tends to happen.

Design your people

1. **List the five people you spend the most time with.** For each, ask if they support or undermine the change you want.
2. **Join one community aligned with it:** a gym or CrossFit box, a running club, a sobriety group, an online course with a forum.
3. **Find one accountability partner** and schedule a weekly check-in (10 minutes is enough).
4. **Say it out loud.** Examples: "I'm not drinking anymore, please don't offer." "I'm working on my health, please don't push food on me."

Design your screen

- Unfollow accounts that make you feel behind, angry or tempted.
- Follow people who teach or inspire the identity you want.
- Turn off all notifications except calls and the messages that matter.
- Use an app blocker during focus time.

Area	Checklist item	Done
Physical	Cues for the unwanted behavior removed or hidden	[ ]
Physical	Cues for the wanted behavior visible and ready	[ ]
Social	One supportive community joined	[ ]
Social	One accountability partner chosen	[ ]
Digital	Triggering accounts unfollowed, notifications reduced	[ ]

CHAPTER 5

A: Act with minimum viable habits

The hardest part of any new behavior is the first minute. So we shrink it until it is nearly impossible to fail. I call this the **minimum viable habit**: the smallest version of the behavior that still counts.

Big goal	Minimum viable habit
Exercise 45 minutes	Put on your training shoes
Read 30 minutes	Read one page
Meditate 10 minutes	Take three slow breaths
Meal prep for the week	Cut one vegetable
Write 1,000 words	Write one sentence

Two reasons this works. First, starting is the bottleneck, and a tiny start removes the bottleneck. Second, once you have started, you often continue, and when you do not, you still kept the chain alive. Do not take my word for it: on the days it works, you will notice it yourself.

The behavior model

Stanford researcher BJ Fogg offers a simple model for thinking about this: a behavior happens when **motivation**, **ability** and a **prompt** come together at the same moment. His practical conclusion is that, since motivation fluctuates, you should make the behavior so easy that it needs very little of it.[3] It is a practical framework used widely in coaching, rather than a law of nature, but it is a very useful way to troubleshoot: when a behavior is not happening, is it missing a prompt, is it too hard, or is the motivation too low?

Habit stacking

The easiest prompt is something you already do. The formula:

> *After I [current habit], I will [tiny new habit].*

- After I pour my morning coffee, I will write one sentence in my journal.

- After I brush my teeth, I will drink a full glass of water (8 oz).
- After I turn on the shower, I will do 5 push-ups and 10 air squats while the water warms up, then step in.
- After I sit down for dinner, I will name one thing that went well.
- After I close my laptop, I will put on my training shoes.

Growing the habit

Once the tiny version feels automatic (Lally's data suggests this can take weeks to months), grow it in **small steps**: one push-up becomes three, then five, then ten. Increase only when the current level feels boring. If you skip two days after an increase, go back one step. There is no deadline.

Why the beginning feels useless

In the first weeks the visible results are small, so many people quit just before the habit takes hold. That is normal and expected. The scoreboard that matters in the beginning is **days done**, not results.

Today

Write your stack: "After I __, *I will* __ (the tiny version)." Do it once tonight.

CHAPTER 6

Your first 30 days

Week	Focus	Your checkpoint
1	Track. Pick your ONE behavior. Log it three times a day.	Seven days of notes
2	Redesign: change two things at home and one on your phone. Find a person or a group.	Environment list done
3	Act: start the tiny version after a stable cue. Celebrate it.	Mark every day
4	Navigate: write three if-then plans. Review your week with the audit.	One adjustment made

Your only target in these 30 days: **not breaking the chain twice in a row.** Everything else is a bonus.

Want more? The complete guide has every chapter, worksheets and the full reference list. adrianonutrition.com/guides

Questions?

Send me a DM on Instagram: @adriano.nutrition. I read every message.

References

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2. Berry, R., et al. (2021). Does self-monitoring diet and physical activity behaviors using digital technology support adults with obesity or overweight to lose weight? A systematic literature review with meta-analysis. *Obesity Reviews*.
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